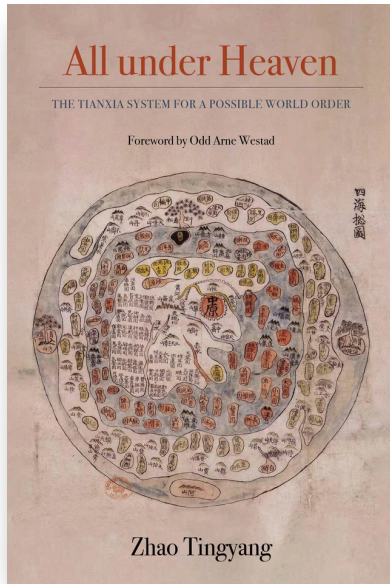


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The Tianxia System for a Possible World Order

by **Tingyang Zhao** (Author), **Joseph E. Harroff** (Translator), **Odd Arne Westad** (Foreword by)

Hardcover	Paperback	eBook
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Price: \$29.95 / £25.00

Publication Date: Jun 2021

Edition: 1st Edition

TITLE DETAILS:

Rights: World

Pages: 332

ISBN: 9780520325029

Trim Size: 6 x 9

SERIES:

Great Transformations (Series Completed)

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About the Book

In this succinct yet ample work, Zhao Tingyang, one of China's most distinguished intellectuals, provides a profoundly original philosophical interpretation of China's story and also develops a Chinese worldview for the future. Over the past few decades, the question *Where did China come from?* has absorbed the thoughts of many of China's best historians. Zhao, keenly aware of the persistent and pernicious asymmetry in the prevailing way scholars have gone about theorizing China according to Western concepts and categories, has tasked both Chinese and Western scholars to "rethink China." Zhao introduces what he terms a distinctively Chinese centripetal "whirlpool" model of world order to interpret the historical progression of China's *tianxia* (All under Heaven) identity construction. In this book, Zhao forwards a compelling thesis not only on how we should understand China, but also on how China until recently has understood itself.

About the Author

Zhao Tingyang is a philosopher of political theory, metaphysics, and philosophy of history. His known theories include *tianxia* as a philosophy of world order, the ontology of coexistence, human rights as credit rights, and the whirlpool power of China.

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"Zhao's fresh ideas, arguments, and methods are important and well done."—Stephen C. Angle, Wesleyan University

"This book allows Western readers to participate in important current discussions in China about globalization and world order."—Fred Dallmayr, University of Notre Dame

"Our broken world might be healed and made whole only when nations and people overcome nation-state animosity and learn to cherish common aspirations beyond parochial agendas. Such a resounding message, conveyed by *tianxia*, finds a refreshing expression in this English rendering of the work of the Chinese philosopher Zhao Tingyang. Updating ancient Chinese philosophy by relating it to Western cosmopolitanism, this well-translated volume brims with insights into crisis-ridden global politics and will intensify the debate about how different nations and cultures can cultivate visions of coexistence and coevolution as a human community."—Ban Wang, Stanford University, editor of *Chinese Visions of World Order*

"Zhao Tingyang offers us a new conception of the political in the form of a world society in which no one is excluded, everyone is respected, and win-win cooperation is the order of the ages. His is a comprehensive vision for a future society inspired by ancient Chinese models. Cynics will say that it is impractical, but idealists will find much to work towards in creating a new *tianxia* system of global governance."—Salvatore Babones, University of Sydney



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